



LAGUNA BEACH awoke Friday to flooded streets and sidewalks from high surf, high tide and a Kelvin wave.

New U.S. sanctions on global criminal court

Action is part of effort to dismantle tribunal over its investigations, especially of Israel.

By Matthew Lee and Molly Quell

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration on Friday imposed sweeping new sanctions on the International Criminal Court as part of its campaign to dismantle the tribunal over investigations into the United States and its allies, notably Israel.

The move drew rebukes from around the world, including from U.S. allies.

U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio announced the sanctions Friday, after the Nobel Peace Prize was awarded to South African jurist Navi Pillay, who has been a judge at the ICC and other international courts and whose selection for the prize was condemned by Israel for her investigative findings on Gaza. President Trump has coveted that prize for himself.

U.S. officials maintained that the timing was coincidental and that the sanctions had been in the works for months.

“We will ban transactions with this rogue court, cutting off their resources and crippling its ability to operate against us,” Rubio said in a video address posted to social media. “The United States and the American people are not subject to the jurisdiction of this fake ICC.”

The sanctions cut the court off from U.S.-based financial services, technology companies and even using U.S. dollars. They set a six-month timeline for U.S. companies and individuals that have business with the court to wind that business down.

The Hague-based ICC, the world’s first permanent war crimes tribunal, denounced the step as an attack on the rule of law and the foundations of international order, themes that Rubio had appeared to embrace only two days ago in a speech in front of the Acropolis in Athens.

“It is an attempt to obstruct the course of justice and to prevent the court from doing what it was created to do,” the court said in

Ex-ICC judge wins Nobel Peace Prize

South Africa’s Navi Pillay honored for a career defending human rights. Israel objects. **WORLD, A2**

Rising tides, flooding herald Rachel’s arrival

By Hannah Fry and Rong-Gong Lin II

Coastal communities from Newport Beach to Long Beach were hit by significant flooding from large waves on Friday as Southern California braces for the arrival of Tropical Storm Rachel, which is expected to make landfall near the California-Mexico border early Sunday.

Rachel’s arrival brings the potential for strong winds, rain and more damaging coastal flooding. If the

current storm trajectory continues, Rachel’s effects will be felt mostly in San Diego County. However, Orange and Los Angeles counties are still forecast to see widespread rain and isolated coastal flooding as a result of the system, according to the National Weather Service.

“Even though the center of Tropical Storm Rachel will be well south of Los Angeles County, the significant swell in the ocean coming initially from the south, and then also phasing with a swell from the west, will

bring coastal flooding concerns from any time from now through Tuesday, peaking on Sunday,” said National Weather Service Meteorologist-in-Charge Ariel Cohen.

The National Weather Service office in San Diego on Friday issued a rare tropical storm watch for most of San Diego County, including areas like San Diego, Chula Vista, Carlsbad and Ocean-side, meaning that tropical storm-force winds are possible somewhere in the area over the next 48 hours. It’s

[See Storm, A6]

HURRICANE ISAIAS: Damaging wind and rain lash the Gulf Coast. **NATION, A6**

Companies are buying up \$4-billion abuse settlement

Victims beset by delays are taking a loss, trading L.A. County’s future payouts for cash up front

By Rebecca Ellis

The man was sure only his lawyers and family knew about his lawsuit against Los Angeles County over sexual abuse he says he endured inside a juvenile hall as a teenager.

The case, filed under a pseudonym, was one of thousands resolved by county officials last year in a historic \$4-billion sex abuse settlement. He asked to remain anonymous to discuss the abuse, which he said was among his most closely held secrets.

So he was bewildered this fall to receive a phone call from a company in Florida that seemed to know all about it.

The unwanted cold caller offered a deal: In exchange for a lump sum of cash

up front, the company would collect his future payouts, which are set to come in installments over the next five years.

“I’m really curious, like, how you got my number?” said the man, according to a recording of the call reviewed by The Times. “This is a very confidential matter. There is no way that you should know my name, let alone my phone number.”

He says he never got an answer. Instead, the salesperson offered him a \$200 referral fee if he could find others to sell their payouts, too.

Offers like these, victims suing L.A. County say, have become inescapable. Over Facebook messages and cold calls,

[See Payouts, A14]

Filling in L.A.’s treeless gaps with ‘built shade’

City puts pop-up canopies, tents to the test in blistering heat wave

By Blanca Begert



A MAN heads toward shade at the Hoover Recreation Center, where a canopy drapes the playground.

Temperatures are finally cooling off this weekend, after a long heat wave that followed the hottest summer on record in downtown Los Angeles. Last Saturday, when it was 103 degrees at Exposition Park, a string of red and yellow cloth sails were strung between streetlights to offer a bit of shade.

The sails, bridging the road between the Lucas Museum of Narrative Art and the Coliseum, provided relief for some of the thousands of people headed to USC’s homecoming football game.

“It really made a difference to be under it,” said Edith de Guzman, co-director of the year-old collaboration called ShadeLA. “It felt miserable to be out walking, but once we were under the shade sails, we hung out for a couple of hours, and it was doable,” she said. Led by UCLA and USC, ShadeLA partners with the city, county and other groups to shield Los Angeles from the blazing sun.

The sheets at Exposition Park were a one-day “micro pilot” with the L.A. Bureau

[See Shade, A9]

LAPD lawsuits since 2019 cost \$480 million

Officer misconduct, traffic accidents and workplace injustices fuel ‘nuclear verdicts.’

By Libor Jany and Sean Greene

The LAPD’s legal bills keep piling up.

The city of Los Angeles has shelled out nearly \$480 million over the last seven and a half years to end legal disputes involving the Police Department, including claims of excessive force, litigation over traffic accidents and cases filed by employees who allegedly faced retaliation after reporting misconduct.

The soaring legal costs have come under greater scrutiny in recent years as Los Angeles’ financial problems have gotten worse. The city faced a \$1-billion budget shortfall in 2025 but, after various cost-cutting measures, managed to set aside funding for the LAPD to hire more than 500 new officers in the coming year.

The LAPD’s annual law-

suit costs more than doubled from 2019 to 2025. The payouts peaked in 2024, when the city spent \$178.6 million to resolve more than 300 police-related lawsuits and civil claims, before dropping to just over \$100 million in 2025, according to a Times analysis of city attorney’s data.

The Times reviewed hundreds of pages of court documents and analyzed data from the city attorney’s office released through a public records request showing nearly 2,000 payouts dating to January 2019.

Through the first six months of this year, the city has paid out \$20.3 million in legal settlements and court judgments involving LAPD officers. Several recent big-dollar verdicts aren’t included in that tally because they hadn’t yet been approved by the City Council.

The surging cost of LAPD payouts is depriving the cash-strapped city of money for pressing needs such as fixing roads and sidewalks, City Controller Kenneth Mejia said.

“There’s a reason why [See LAPD, A14]

Public execution plan draws disgust

Bipartisan outrage over Pentagon intent to livestream killing of Ft. Hood shooter.

By Kevin Rector and Ana Ceballos

In confirming his plans to livestream Ft. Hood mass shooter Nidal Malik Hasan’s military execution by firing squad on Dec. 3, Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth called it a “no brainer” punishment for a “radical Islamist terror attack” on U.S. service members.

“We’ll make sure that people are able to watch it, that it’s public, because people need to understand [that] there are serious consequences for these types of things,” Hegseth said in an interview with Real America’s Voice network.

Others across the country and around the world — Democrats and Republicans, human rights experts, legal scholars and military and religious leaders — con-

demned it as a barbaric throwback to an era when executions were cast as entertainment, and as the world’s leading democracy adopting a form of punishment carried out in modern times only by authoritarian regimes and terrorist organizations.

“Hasan should face the death penalty, but making his execution public and streaming it? Beyond disgusting,” Sen. Thom Tillis (R-N.C.) wrote on X. “Public executions are what oppressive dictatorships like Iran and Afghanistan do. It should not be happening in America.”

“I absolutely support the sentence of death, but livestreaming executions is what jihadists do. America is better than that,” Rep. Austin Scott (R-Ga.) wrote.

The United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights said that “the livestreaming of an execution is tantamount to a public execution and would breach the absolute prohibition of torture.” The head of

[See Livestream, A7]



Ed Wagner Chicago Tribune

BEARS LEGEND DITKA DIES

The intense coach, yelling at Jim Harbaugh, led Chicago’s iconic 1985 Super Bowl team after a Hall of Fame career as a tight end. **SPORTS, B12**

Deal struck for Russian diesel

Trump reaches pact with Putin, relaxing years of U.S. pressure on Moscow ahead of midterms. **NATION, A4**

Weather

An afternoon shower. L.A. Basin: 82/68. **B8**

Markets **A11**
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ICE shoots man in NYC

Officials say he drove into officers’ vehicles. A 5-year-old was also in the car. **NATION, A5**

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